A-A-51582A
20 August 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051582(DM)
4 August 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

GUIDE, SHADE, DENTAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This commercial item description covers a shade selection guide for use in color selection of prosthetic teeth.

Salient characteristics:

The shade guide shall be suitable for use in the selection of the most appropriate shade for both porcelain and plastic teeth, and shade selection in the preparation of fixed restorations and removable prostheses, including ceramic and plastic prostheses.

The shade guide shall consist of 24 individual correlated selector sets of plastic teeth in shades B51, B52, B53, B54, B55, B56,B59, B62, B63, B65, B66, B67, B69, B77, B81, B83, B84, B85, B91, B92, B93, B94, B95, and B96.

The 24 teeth shall be in 4 shade groups: the reddish brown range, the yellow range, the gray range, and the reddish gray range.

The teeth shall have a bright polished finish.

The teeth shall be furnished in a suitable plastic holder. Each tooth shall be securely mounted on a metal or plastic tab. The holder shall be 8 to 9 inches long, 1-1/2 to 1-3/4 inches wide, and 1/4 to 3/8 inch deep. The tooth and tab shall be 2 to 2-1/4 inches long. Each tab shall be individually removable from the holder.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The tabs and the holder shall be labelled with the related shade number. The tabs shall be firmly held in the holder by a friction fit. When removing one tab from the holder, all other tabs shall remain firmly in place. When holder is inverted, no tab shall lose fit and fall from the holder.

The shade guide shall not be harmed by sanitizing with a cold sterilizing solution. Instructions for cold sterilization shall be furnished.

Workmanship. The shade guide shall have no discoloration, crazing, checking or any damaged parts and shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One shade guide, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be one shade guide. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level II, AQL 2.5, and sampling for tests (when applicable) shall be conducted at inspection level S-1, AQL 1.0.

Examination. The shade guide shall be examined for defects including, but not limited to, those listed below:

Defects

Holder does not contain all 24 shades of teeth.
Dimensions of shade guide not as specified.
Tabs of teeth do not fit firmly in holder.
Tabs of teeth are not labeled with shade number.
Holder is not labeled with shade number.
Teeth are not arranged in 4 shade groups.
Teeth are not free from discoloration, crazing and checking.
Teeth do not have a bright polished finish.
Shade guide has damaged parts.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES:

1. Shade numbers, refer to Dentsply/York Division Trubyte Bioform Shades.

2. The following National Stock Number is covered by this document.

Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-01-139-9239	GUIDE, SHADE, DENTAL, Reddish Brown, Yellow, Gray, and Reddish Gray Ranges, 24 shades

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

59064

Preparing Activity:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA - DM

PROJECT NO. 6520-2377

LOCATION: WORD/GUIDE/SHAPE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and filed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 Alexandria, VA

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51582A	GUIDE, SHADE, DENTAL

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify)

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Code) – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

DD FORM 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.